

American Express

CFPB Complaints Analysis

EDA · Key Insights · Recommendations · Risk Mitigation

Jan 2025 – Mar 2026 | 196,835 Complaints | 9 Companies

196,835

Total Complaints

9

Companies

6.9%

AmEx Market Share

99.0%

Timely Response Rate

13,665

AmEx Complaints

#7 of 9

AmEx Complaint Rank

Prepared for Senior Leadership

AGENDA

01

Exploratory Data Analysis

Slide 2

Monthly trends, company rankings, product mix breakdown, and top complaint issue categories across 196,835 CFPB complaints

02

Key Insights

Slide 2

Six data-backed findings — AmEx's competitive advantage, rising industry volumes, credit reporting issues, dispute gaps, promo credibility, and debt collection risks

03

Business Recommendations

Slide 3

Three prioritised actions tied directly to complaint data: dispute resolution reform, promotional clarity, and debt collection overhaul

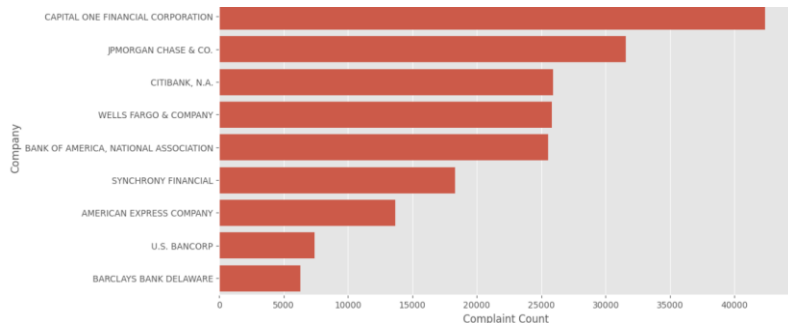
04

Risks & Mitigation Strategies

Slide 3

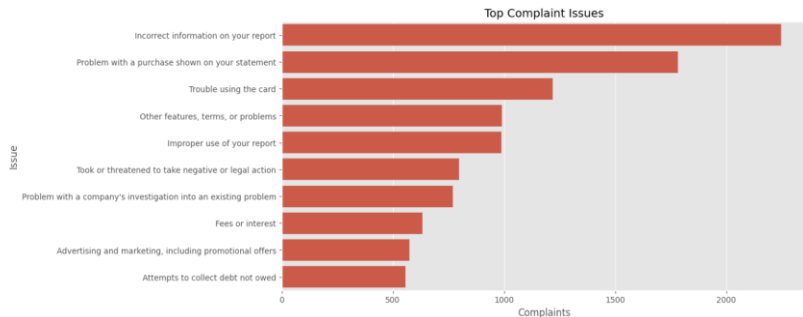
Regulatory enforcement risk (HIGH), brand erosion risk (MEDIUM), and customer attrition risk (MEDIUM) — each with a proposed mitigation strategy

Complaint Volume by Company



AmEx ranks #7 of 9 — 3× fewer complaints than Capital One (21.5% vs 6.9%)

Top Complaint Issues



Credit report errors lead (2,248). Purchase disputes #2 at 1,784 — 83% say unresolved by AmEx

Key Insights

AmEx has 3× fewer complaints than Capital One

6.9% complaint share vs 21.5% — lowest among major card issuers. Premium positioning = fewer disputes.

Monthly complaints increased from ~11K in early 2025 to ~16K by early 2026.

The upward trend suggests increasing customer expectations and regulatory focus, making proactive complaint management essential.

Credit report errors are the #1 complaint category

2,248 complaints. Customers say wrong balances or wrong account status — damaging their credit scores.

Purchase disputes are losing customers

1,784 complaints. AmEx monetary relief rate: 14.9% vs BofA's 36.7%. Customers feel rejected.

Promo promises aren't being kept

574 complaints, ~2× peer avg. 74% say they never received the offer they signed up for.

Debt collection contradicts premium brand

1,759 complaints (13% of total). 45% cite unnecessary legal threats — wrong tone for a premium brand.

Business Recommendations

01 Improve Dispute Resolution

- Reduce turnaround time for purchase dispute investigations.
- Provide proactive status updates throughout the dispute process.
- Monitor dispute resolution trends to identify recurring issues.
- Benchmark complaint resolution performance against leading competitors.

💡 Faster dispute resolution improves customer satisfaction and reduces repeat complaints.

02 Improve Promotional Transparency

- Simplify promotional terms and eligibility criteria.
- Ensure marketing communications clearly explain offer conditions.
- Review promotional complaints regularly to identify recurring themes.
- Strengthen collaboration between Marketing, Product, and Compliance.

💡 Clear communication reduces customer confusion and builds trust.

03 Enhance Collection Experience

- Review collection practices for consistency and compliance.
- Offer early support options for customers facing payment difficulties.
- Use customer-friendly communication throughout the collections process.
- Regularly monitor debt collection complaint trends.

💡 A customer-centric collections approach helps protect AmEx's premium brand.

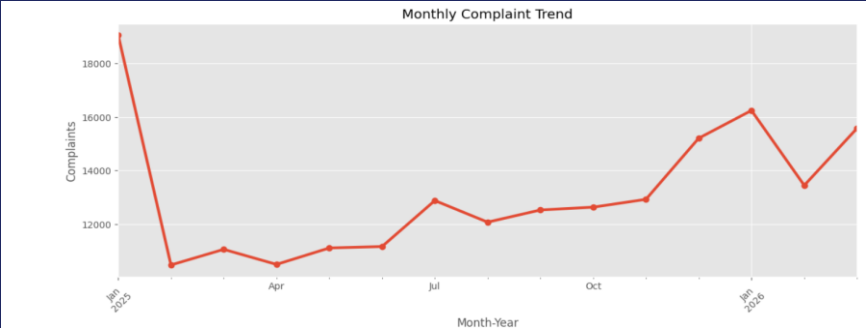
Risk & Mitigation

Risk	Severity	What the Data Shows	Mitigation Strategy
Regulatory Action (CFPB Enforcement)	HIGH	574 advertising complaints (9.3% of CC complaints), nearly 2× the peer average.	Simplify offer terms, strengthen compliance reviews, and monitor complaint trends.
Brand Erosion (Premium Perception)	MEDIUM	1,759 debt collection complaints (13% of total) indicate a key customer pain point.	Improve collection practices, offer hardship support, and use customer-friendly communication.
Customer Attrition (Dispute Dissatisfaction)	MEDIUM	1,784 purchase disputes; AmEx monetary relief rate (14.9%) trails BoFA (36.7%).	Speed up dispute resolution, improve communication, and benchmark against industry leaders.

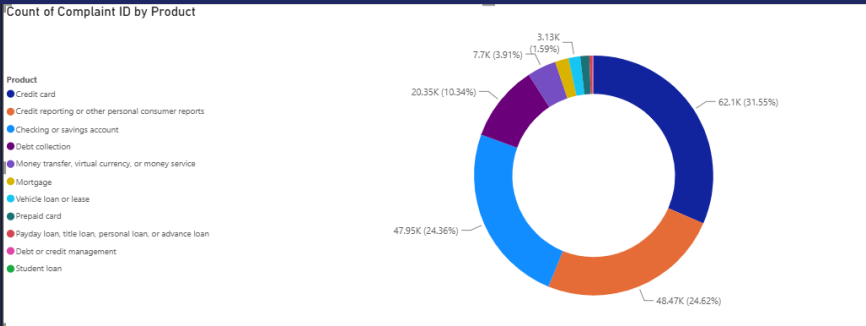
Bottom Line: AmEx's 6.9% complaint share is a genuine competitive advantage — but dispute resolution, promotional credibility, and debt collection represent concentrated brand risks that must be addressed to protect annual fee revenue.

APPENDIX — DATA SUMMARY

Monthly Trend (All Companies)



Product Mix — Market (196,835 Complaints)



AmEx vs. Competitors — Key Metrics

Metric	AmEx	Best	Worst
Complaint Market Share	6.9%	3.2% (Barclays)	21.5% (Cap One)
Total Complaints (period)	13,665	6,297 (Barclays)	42,365 (Cap One)
Timely Response Rate	99.0%	100% (multiple)	98.4% (Synchrony)
Monetary Relief Rate (all)	12.2%	23.5% (BofA)	3.5% (Barclays)
CC Monetary Relief Rate	14.9%	36.7% (BofA)	7.0% (Barclays)
Ad Complaint Share (CC)	9.3%	~4.8% (avg)	—